

where the browser window (or possibly an all-encompassing containing element) is 100 per cent. An advantage of a liquid layout is that it adapts to suit the available viewing space. However, while this is favourable for window widths from, say, 700 pixels to 1024 pixels, at larger window sizes sentences can become incredibly long and difficult to follow line by line. It is also more difficult to design images and banner elements to fit liquid columns, where graphics may need to acknowledge the stretching or expanding containing element and attempt to fit. The max-width CSS property can be applied to stop the expansion of the layout at a set width. Regrettably, IE6 and below on the PC do not support this.



A Liquid Layout

9.1.3 Elastic

The concept of the elastic layout is interesting, but it has its difficulties. While an elastic layout isn't fixed, it is also stopped from getting too wide, as you can specify a maximum width and a minimum width in pixels, ems, or percentages. The benefit here is how the whole layout can scale when text is resized. The elastic layout is a more advanced layout option beyond our scope right now, but if you are curious, Patrick Griffith's article "Elastic